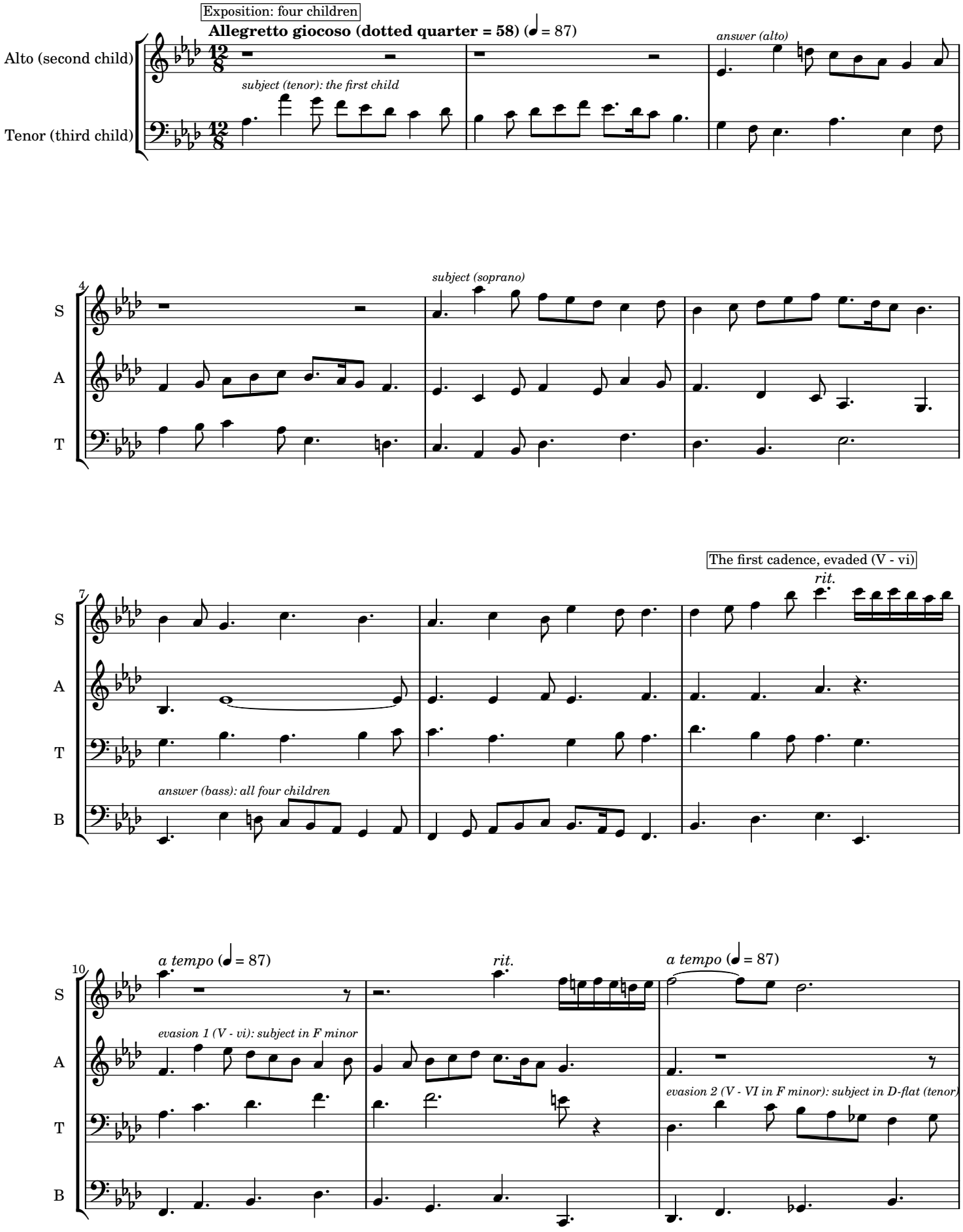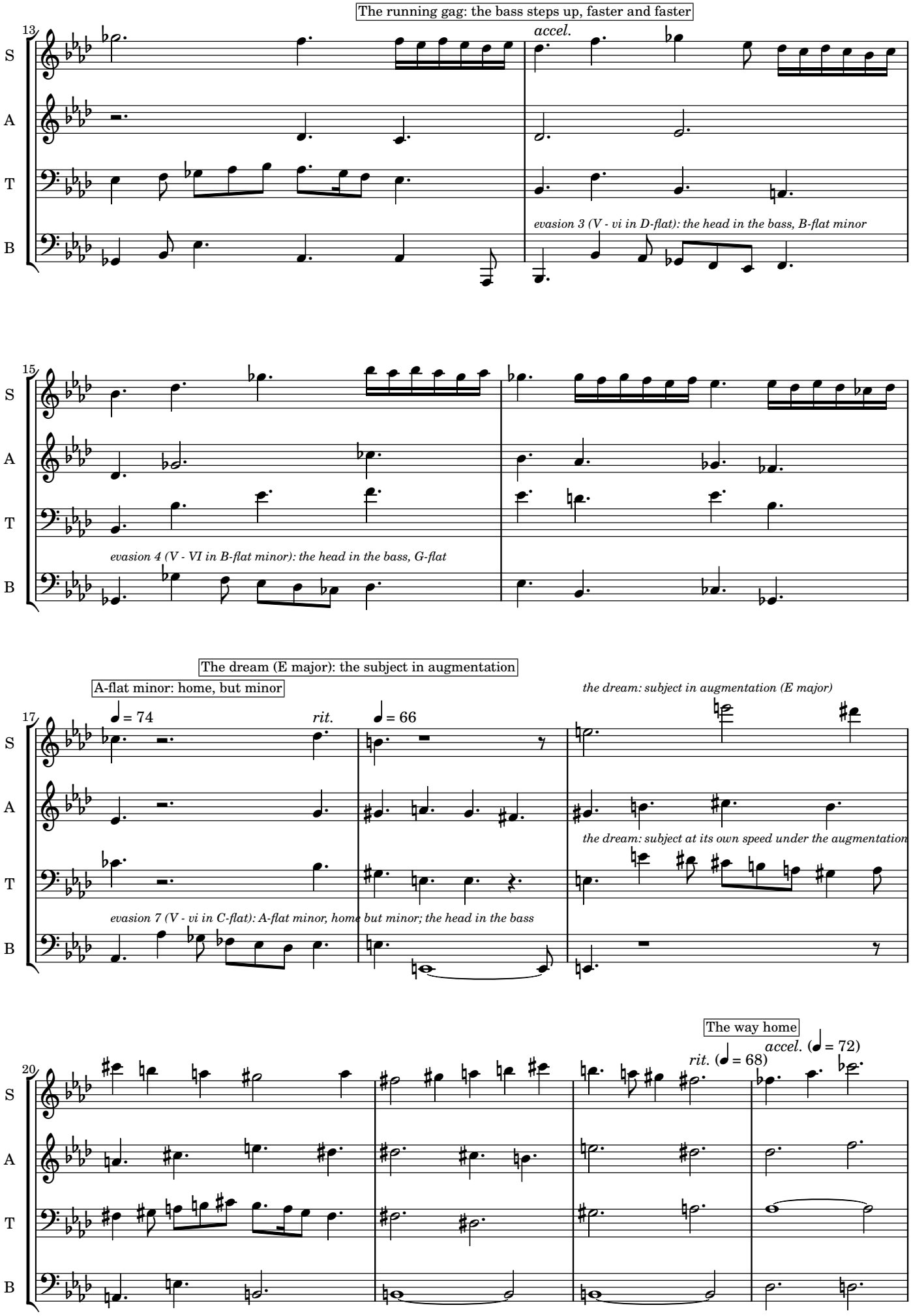# The Well-Tempered clAIvier
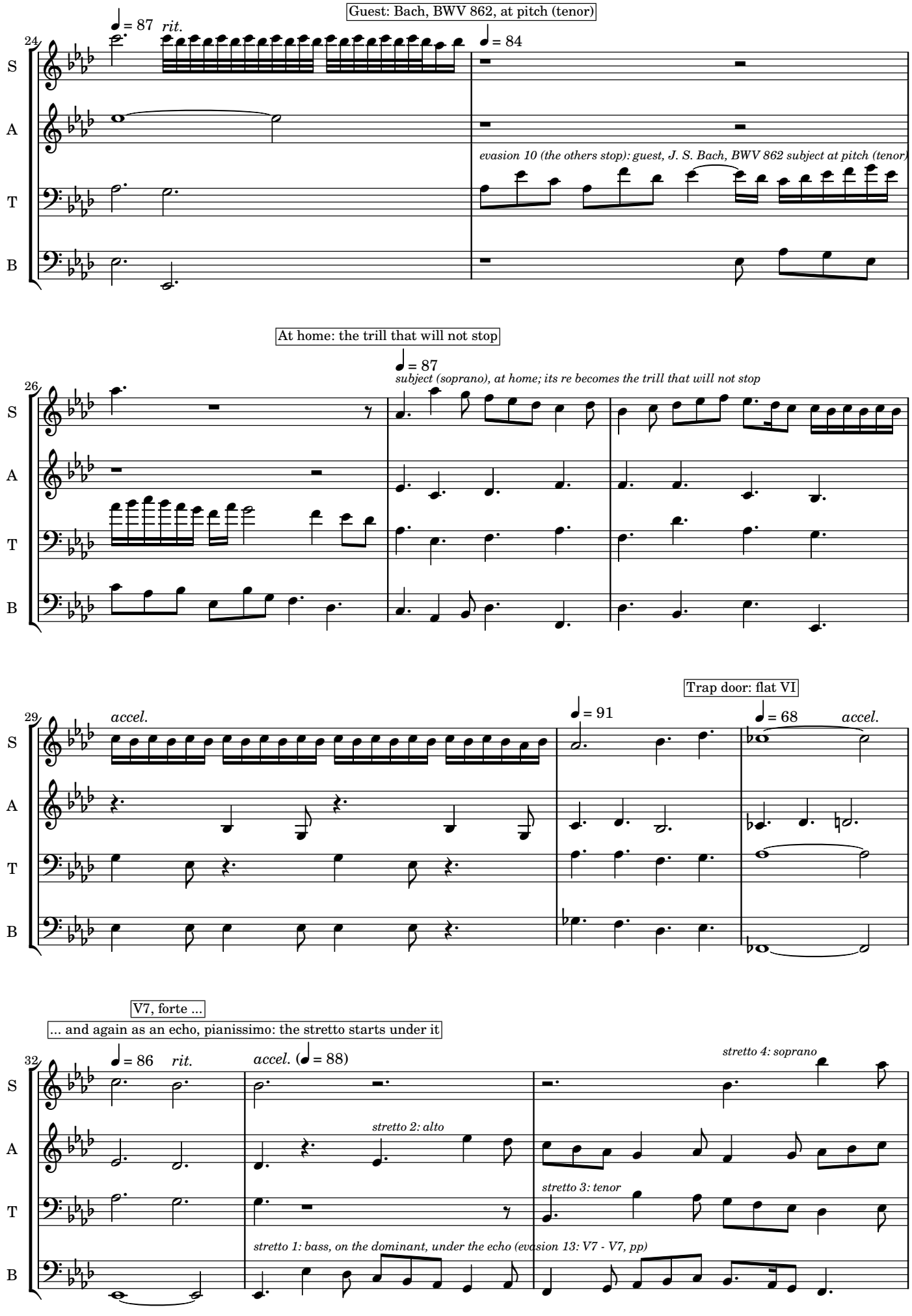
## XVII. Fugue in A-flat major: Fuga, fuggendo la cadenza
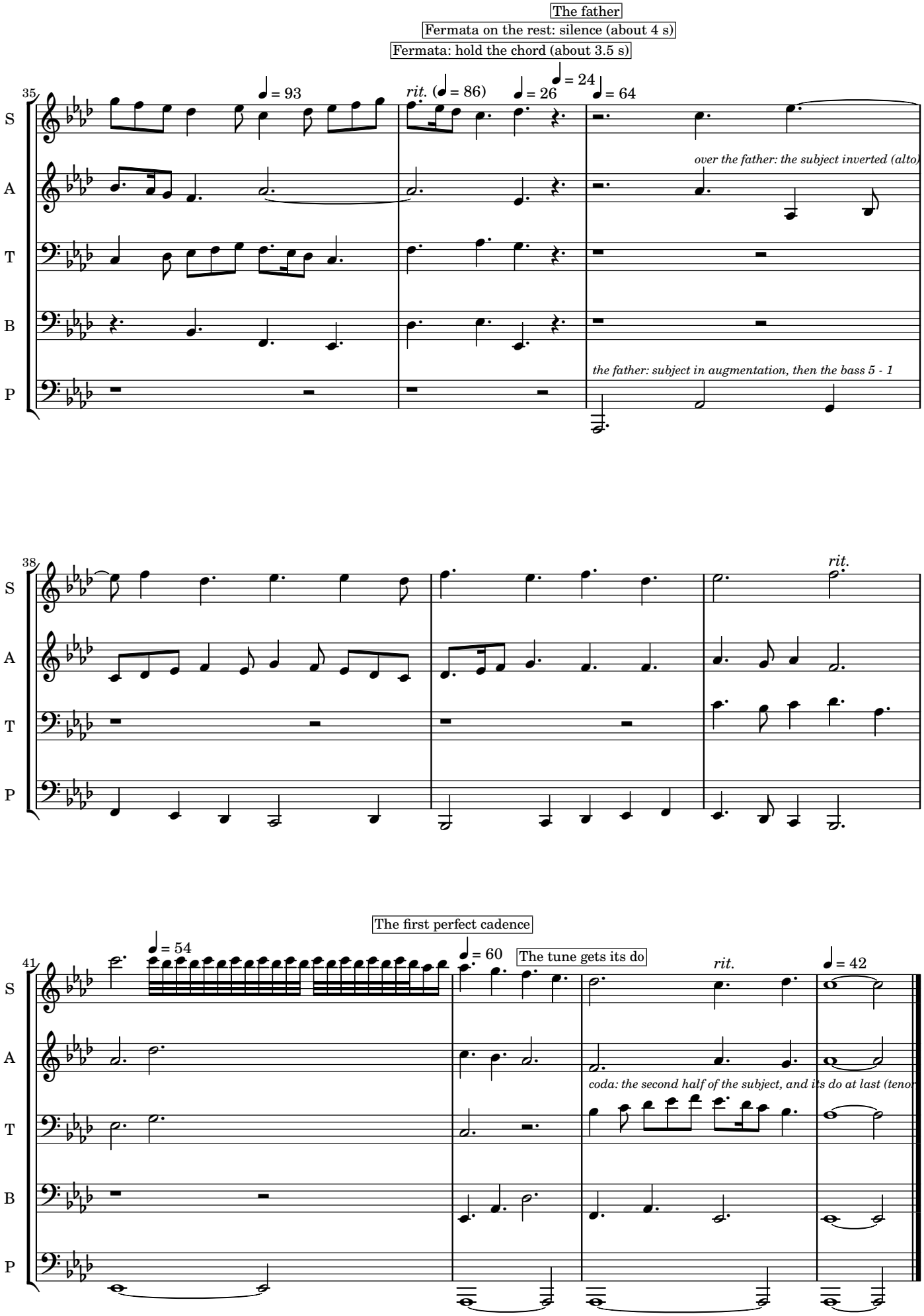
**Piano (four voices; a fifth, the father, at the end)**

Claude / composed for Sam (guest subject: J. S. Bach, BWV 862)




The running gag: the bass steps up, faster and faster
13
S
A
T
B
accel.
evasion 3 (V - vi in D-flat): the head in the bass, B-flat minor
15
evasion 4 (V - VI in B-flat minor): the head in the bass, G-flat
The dream (E major): the subject in augmentation
A-flat minor: home, but minor
17
♩ = 74
rit.
♩ = 66
the dream: subject in augmentation (E major)
the dream: subject at its own speed under the augmentation
evasion 7 (V - vi in C-flat): A-flat minor, home but minor; the head in the bass
The way home
20
rit. (♩ = 68)
accel. (♩ = 72)


Guest: Bach, BWV 862, at pitch (tenor)
24
♩= 87 rit.
♩= 84
S
A
T
B
evasion 10 (the others stop): guest, J. S. Bach, BWV 862 subject at pitch (tenor)
At home: the trill that will not stop
26
♩= 87
subject (soprano), at home; its re becomes the trill that will not stop
Trap door: flat VI
29
accel.
♩= 91
♩= 68
accel.
V7, forte ...
... and again as an echo, pianissimo: the stretto starts under it
32
♩= 86 rit.
accel. (♩= 88)
stretto 4: soprano
stretto 2: alto
stretto 3: tenor
stretto 1: bass, on the dominant, under the echo (evasion 13: V7 - V7, pp)


The father
Fermata on the rest: silence (about 4 s)
Fermata: hold the chord (about 3.5 s)
35
S
A
T
B
P
♩ = 93
rit. (♩ = 86)
♩ = 26
♩ = 24
♩ = 64
over the father: the subject inverted (alto)
the father: subject in augmentation, then the bass 5 - 1
38
rit.
The first perfect cadence
41
♩ = 54
♩ = 60
The tune gets its do
rit.
♩ = 42
coda: the second half of the subject, and its do at last (teno